

most frequently repackaged apps are games and legitimate apps downloaded from “free” web sites. That’s why you should always download apps from official web sites. Sometimes repackaged apps are hosted in the Android Market/AppStore. They look similar to the original apps however they differ in their permissions. The repackaged apps ask for more permissions than required. Although Google and Apple are trying hard to remove such apps, it never hurts to be careful.

Even if you install a legitimate app, you can be the victim of an Update Attack. Malware writers first create a malware-free app and when they have a large user base, the creator updates the application with a malicious version. Because many users have their devices set to automatically update applications or will manually update whenever a new version is available, the update attack technique minimises the amount of time the malware is in the market before it’s installed on a large number of devices.

Phew! That’s a quite a lot of malware. In the coming chapters we’ll give you tips on how to stay protected. 



The internet is a double-edged sword; it can just as easily harm you